

CASE ID: 201907710713

EPISODE NAME: Taiwan Tourism Restriction

2019/07/31 - Ongoing

Sender: China (710)

Target: Taiwan (713)

Issue: Solve Territorial Dispute (5)

Final Outcome: Stalemate after Sanctions Imposition (9)

Narrative:

On 2019/07/31, China announced it would suspend a program that allowed 82,000 individual tourists from China to travel to Taiwan, meaning that tourism into Taiwan would increasingly have to take place in tour groups. The policy went into effect on 2019/08/01.¹ Despite this being expected to decrease tourist spending in Taiwan, Taiwan had record tourism the year before in 2018, with revenues of \$12 billion USD mostly not coming from China.² Chinese tourists made up 3 million of the 18 million tourists to Taiwan, and most of them came in tour groups, which were not targeted by China's sanction on 2019/08/01.³

China's sanction was in retaliation to Taiwanese President Tsai Ing-wen's continued refusal to endorse the "1992 Consensus," which claims that Taiwan is the rightful territory of China, since her election in 2016/01/16, and during her re-election campaign in 2019.⁴ Taiwan reported record tourism in 2019 despite China's ban on independent tourism, with visitors from other countries compensating for the drop in Chinese tourism.⁵ China's restriction of independent tourism is ongoing.

¹ Jennings, Ralph. "Taiwan Will Easily Overcome China's Ban On 82,000 Tourists Per Month." *Forbes*, August 15th, 2019. <https://www.forbes.com/sites/ralphjennings/2019/08/15/taiwan-will-easily-overcome-chinas-ban-on-82000-tourists-per-month/>.

² Ibid.

³ Ibid.

⁴ Hancock, Tom and Nian Liu. "China suspends individual tourist permits to Taiwan before election." *Financial Times*, 31 July 2019, <https://www.ft.com/content/6ba14934-b35e-11e9-8cb2-799a3a8cf37b>.

⁵ Campbell, Charlie. "Taiwan President Tsai Ing-wen Wins Reelection With Record Support." *TIME*, January 11th, 2020. <https://time.com/5762629/taiwan-tsai-ing-wen-reelected>.